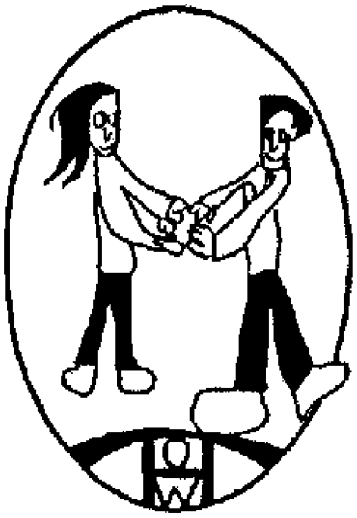
Howbridge Infant School



SMSC Policy

Date last reviewed by Governing Body: October 2025

Aims and priorities for subject teaching and learning

At Howbridge Infant School we recognise that the personal development of students, spiritually, morally, socially and culturally, plays a significant part in their ability to learn and achieve. We aim to provide an education that gives children opportunities to explore and develop their own values and beliefs, spiritual awareness, high standards of personal behaviour, a positive caring attitude towards people and an understanding of their social and cultural traditions.

We believe that:

- All curriculum areas have a contribution to make to the child's spiritual, moral, social and cultural development.
- All adults will model and promote expected behaviour, treating all people as unique and valuable individuals and showing care and respect for students and their families.
- Students should learn to differentiate right and wrong, in as far as their actions affect others.
- Students should understand the need for rules within our community.
- Students should be prepared to cope with the demands of Modern Day Britain

General aims:

- To ensure that everyone connected with the school is aware of our values.
- To ensure a consistent approach to the delivery of SMSC issues through the general life of the school.
- To ensure that students know what is expected of them and why.
- To give students an opportunity to reflect and discuss feelings and beliefs.
- To enable students to appreciate and understand cultures and traditions.
- To enable students to explore and develop a sense of social and moral responsibility.
- To enable students to take part in a range of activities requiring social skills.

Spiritual, moral, social and cultural development is defined by:

1. The spiritual development of pupils is shown by their:

    - ability to be reflective about their own beliefs, religious or otherwise, that inform their perspective on life and their interest in and respect for different people's faiths, feelings and values
    - sense of enjoyment and fascination in learning about themselves, others and the world around them
    - use of imagination and creativity in their learning
    - willingness to reflect on their experiences.

2. The moral development of pupils is shown by their:

    - ability to recognise the difference between right and wrong and to readily apply this understanding in their own lives, recognise legal boundaries and, in so doing, respect the civil and criminal law of England
    - understanding of the consequences of their behaviour and actions
    - interest in investigating and offering reasoned views about moral and ethical issues and ability to understand and appreciate the viewpoints of others on these issues.

3. The social development of pupils is shown by their:

- use of a range of social skills in different contexts, for example working and socialising with other pupils, including those from different religious, ethnic and socio-economic backgrounds
- willingness to participate in a variety of communities and social settings, including by volunteering, cooperating well with others and being able to resolve conflicts effectively
- acceptance and engagement with the fundamental British values of democracy, the rule of law, individual liberty and mutual respect and tolerance of those with different faiths and beliefs; they develop and demonstrate skills and attitudes that will allow them to participate fully in and contribute positively to life in modern Britain.

4. The cultural development of pupils is shown by their:

- understanding and appreciation of the wide range of cultural influences that have shaped their own heritage and those of others
- understanding and appreciation of the range of different cultures within school and further afield as an essential element of their preparation for life in modern Britain
- knowledge of Britain's democratic parliamentary system and its central role in shaping our history and values, and in continuing to develop Britain
- willingness to participate in and respond positively to artistic, musical, sporting and cultural opportunities
- interest in exploring, improving understanding of and showing respect for different faiths and cultural diversity and the extent to which they understand, accept, respect and celebrate diversity, as shown by their tolerance and attitudes towards different religious, ethnic and socio-economic groups in the local, national and global communities.

<u>British Values</u>

The British Values of democracy, the rule of law, individual liberty, mutual respect for and tolerance of those with different faiths and beliefs and for those without faith are explored in all subject lessons and in school assemblies with evidence recorded in each class when this is achieved.

We aim to:

- Enable students to develop their self-knowledge, self-esteem and self-confidence
- Enable students to distinguish right from wrong and to respect the civil and criminal law of England
- Encourage students to accept responsibility for their behaviour, show initiative, and to understand how they can contribute positively to the lives of those living and working in the locality of the school and to society more widely
- Enable students to acquire a broad general knowledge of and respect for public institutions and services in England
- Further tolerance and harmony between different cultural traditions by enabling students to acquire an appreciation for and respect for their own and other cultures
- Encourage respect for other people

- Encourage respect for democracy and support for participation in the democratic processes, including respect for the basis on which the law is made and applied in England

Sources used for the scheme of work

Development in SMSC will take place across all curriculum areas, within activities that encourage students to recognise the spiritual dimension of their learning and the challenges and implications on their own attitude and lifestyle. All curriculum areas should seek illustrations and examples drawn from as wide a range of cultural contexts as possible.
This can be done by class discussions, in small groups, performances and visits / talks from outside speakers.
In planning lessons, teachers are aware of the need to plan opportunities to develop a wide variety of spiritual, moral, social and cultural needs. A vast majority will be delivered through cross curricular activities as well as specific PSHE, RE and Circle Time activities, alongside exploration of British Values. The development of children's spiritual, moral, social and cultural needs are also addressed through our PSHE Jigsaw scheme of work and our RE scheme (SAT RE). Picture News is also delivered across year groups which helps to develop children's understanding of others and their opinions in a debate style discussion.

Visitors

Where possible, visitors are welcome into our school to support promotion of SMSC during lesson and assembly times. Visitors may be linked to a particular subject e.g. Reverends for RE or for general core value promotion e.g. emergency services.

Strategies for teaching

Whole school core values and exploration of British Values are used to underpin promotion of all SMSC areas by all staff and pupils throughout the whole school day.

Spiritual Development

Planned opportunities for spiritual development in all subjects can be seen across the school. Children are given opportunities to reflect upon the meaning of spiritual experiences.

Examples of experiences commonly regarded as spiritual include:

- Curiosity and mystery
- Awe and wonder
- Connection and belonging
- Heightened self-awareness
- Prayer and worship
- Deep feelings of what is felt to be ultimately important
- A sense of security, well-being, worth and purposefulness

The school will develop a climate or ethos within which all pupils can grow and flourish, respect others and be respected; accommodating difference and respecting the integrity of individuals. These can occur during any part of the school day, eg. when listening to music, discussing the care needed for animals, exercising empathy or creativity, how we live, contemplating the future, etc.

Moral Development

Our school develops pupil moral development by:

- Providing a clear moral code as a basis for behaviour which is promoted consistently through all aspects of the school
- Promoting racial, religious and other forms of equality
- Giving pupils opportunities across the curriculum to explore and develop moral concepts and values – for example, personal rights and responsibilities, truth, justice, equality of opportunity, right and wrong
- Developing an open and safe learning environment in which pupils can express their views and practice moral decision making
- Rewarding expressions of moral insights and good behaviour
- Recognising and respecting the codes and morals of the different cultures represented in the school and wider community

- Encouraging pupils to take responsibility for their actions, for example, respect for property, care of the environment, and developing codes of behaviour, reinforcing the school's values through images, posters, classroom displays, etc.

Teachers discuss classroom and school expectations, based on the core values held by the school. We teach the children to be aware of their own actions, take responsibility for their own bodies and encourage independence. We will help the children to identify their feelings and think these through so that they are expressed in behaviour that is socially acceptable.
This is done through collective worship, circle time, intervention groups and Jigsaw/PSHE sessions. We are interested in the development of the whole child and will endeavour to raise their self-esteem through praise, stickers and other means that highlight both academic and social achievements.

Social Development

We develop pupil social development by:

- Identifying school core values and principles on which school and community life is based
- Fostering a sense of community, with common, inclusive values
- Promoting racial, religious and other forms of equality
- Encouraging pupils to work cooperatively
- Encouraging pupils to recognise and respect social differences and similarities
- Providing positive experiences to reinforce our values as a school community – for example, through assemblies, school councils, school productions
- Helping pupils develop personal qualities which are valued in society, for example, thoughtfulness, honesty, respect for difference, moral principles, independence, self-respect and an awareness of others' needs
- Providing opportunities for engaging in the democratic process through council elections and participating in community life
- Providing opportunities for pupils to exercise leadership and responsibility
- Providing positive and effective links with the world of work and the wider community

Cultural Development

Our school develops pupils' cultural development by:

- Extending pupils' knowledge and use of cultural imagery and language
- Encouraging them to think about special events in life and how they are celebrated
- Recognising and nurturing particular gifts and talents; providing opportunities for pupils to participate in literature, drama, music, art, crafts and other cultural events and encouraging pupils to reflect on their significance
- Reinforcing the school's cultural links through displays, posters, exhibitions, etc. As well as developing partnerships with outside agencies and individuals to extend pupils' cultural awareness, for example, school visits
- Celebrating and exploring diversity throughout the school year, including Black History, covering a range of figures in History, British Values sessions and assemblies on tolerance and respect, Jigsaw PSHE units on 'Celebrating Differences' and sharing books with a theme on diversity with the children.

Whole school core values are explored which underpin all areas of children's SMSC development. Core values are explored through whole school and class assemblies as well as when they arise throughout each day.

Planning, marking and feedback

SMSC is planned as a thread through all subjects in weekly planning. As well as this, discrete core values, school and class assemblies, Jigsaw lessons, P4C and British Values sessions are used to promote SMSC values. Bloom's Taxonomy questions, Local and global issues that arise and

celebrations of significant past events are also used to promote SMSC values. Verbal feedback is given to children to show their successes and areas for progression, as well as deepen their understanding.

Assessment, recording and reporting

The SMSC co-ordinator is responsible for assessing the SMSC provision in the school. Yearly self-evaluation forms and action plans are completed for each area to show current provision and identify gaps of learning across the school.
Class teachers record children's participation in SMSC activities through class mindmaps and quotes from individuals are often recorded as part of P4C, Picture News and British Values sessions.

Inclusion - equal opportunities, racial awareness, gender, more able, SEN

We aim to set suitable learning targets, respond to pupils diverse needs and overcome potential barriers to learning and assessment for groups and individuals and follow the guidance set out in pages 30–37 of The National Curriculum Handbook, Key Stage 1 and 2.
Approaches are adapted to individual SEN needs to ensure all children can meet learning intentions and barriers are removed for all children. Children who are identified as exceeding the end of year expectations for their age range will have knowledge deepened and stretched to master skills and knowledge. Racial diversity will be taken into account to ensure that religions from all children's backgrounds are explored and celebrated. Moral, racial and ethical issues occur in everyday school days and discussions: e.g. respect for and care of one another, bullying in the playground, looking after new children in school, and are dealt with as they arise. A range of religions are explored and respected within school through RE lessons and across the curriculum. Caring, co-operation, self-awareness, relationships, independence and self-discipline are aspects of development that are strongly encouraged at Howbridge Infant School and are further referred to in the Behaviour and PSHE policies. Whole school Core Values are used to support the positive development of children's attitudes and beliefs towards themselves and others. Core Values are used to explore positive values through discussion, role-play, music, art, games and observation.
As explained in the RE policy parents have the right to withdraw their children from explicit R.E. teaching. An opportunity is provided for them to discuss relevant issues with the teaching staff and, if necessary, appropriate arrangements are made. If they wish to withdraw their child, we request that this is in writing and that it is for individual units not individual lessons.

Resource use, monitoring and acquisition

The school manual for budget holders sets out the financial regulations and procedures for the acquisition of resources.
Day-to-day support for RE delivery and resourcing is provided by the RE co-ordinator. Resources are kept in cupboards in the Year 2 corridor and resources are itemised by Religion. These are clearly labelled to ensure resources can be found easily to support learning. These are monitored by the R.E. co-ordinator to ensure resources are of a high quality and safe to use. All resources are reviewed annually and new items bought on a priority basis, according to the budget for the academic year. A full list of resources can be found in Assessment Drive /Curriculum and subject leadership information /RE/Resources. New resources can be asked for on assessment forms or by email to the RE Co-ordinator.

Links with other subjects

SMSC is planned explicitly through PSHE, RE, Core values, Assemblies, Picture News and British value sessions and as a running thread through daily school life.

Monitoring and evaluation of teaching and learning

Procedures for monitoring teaching and learning are set out in subject management, assessment and other support policies.
Provision for SMSC is monitored and reviewed by:

- Monitoring of by co-ordinator through self-evaluation and action plans

- Regular discussion with staff.
- Audit of policy and schemes of work.
- Sharing good practise.
- Collation of evidence in school portfolio.
- School Improvement Plan.

Staff and school development

Areas for review and development are identified through group and whole staff discussion. School–led training, such as at staff meetings, led by the curriculum coordinator are used to support teachers development and understanding of SMSC teaching, assessment and learning following courses attended from outside providers when needed/available. Action plans are created and reviewed by the co-ordinator annually to address school development needs and progress teaching and learning for SMSC

Review

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